

Equations

An equation is something of the form
one expression = another expression

"Statement of Equality"

These expressions are typically algebraic
e.g. $x^2 - 5 = 4x$ (we'll come back to this example)
↓
quadratic equation

The solutions/roots of an equation are numbers you can plug in for the variables that make the equation true

We break down equations into 3 classes based on their solution sets (set of all solutions):

Equation is of the identity type if it is true for every value in its domain

e.g. $x+3=x+3$, $\left(\frac{5}{x-1} = \frac{5}{x-1}\right)$, $x^2+y=x^2+y$

true
for all
 $x \neq 1$

" $0=0$ " type equations

An equation is of the conditional type if it is true only for some values in its domain

e.g. $x+3=1$, $\frac{5}{x-1}=1$, $x^2+y=1$
 $\downarrow -1$ $\downarrow x=6$ $\downarrow y=1-x^2$
 $(x=2)$

" $x=0$ " type equations

An equation is of the contradiction type if it is not true for any value in its domain

e.g. $x+3=x+3+1$, $\frac{5}{x-1} = \frac{5+4}{x-1}$, $\frac{5}{x-1} = 0$,
 $x^2+y=y-1 \rightarrow x^2=-1$

equations are equivalent if they have exactly the same solution sets

e.g. $x=0, 2x=0, x^2=0$
equivalent

$x=1, 2x=1, x^2=1$
all inequivalent

Solve: $6x-7=2x+5$

$\Rightarrow 6x = 2x + 5 + 7$

$\Rightarrow 6x = 2x + 12$

$\Rightarrow 6x - 2x = 12$

$\Rightarrow 4x = 12$

$\Rightarrow \boxed{x=3}$

equivalent

$$\therefore (3x-2)^2 = (x-5)(9x+4)$$

$$9x^2 - 12x + 4 = 9x^2 + 4x - 45x - 20$$

$$-12x + 4 = -41x - 20$$

$$29x = 16 - 24$$

$$x = \frac{16 - 24}{29}$$

$$x = \frac{-24}{29}$$

Solve:

$$\frac{3x}{x-2} = 1 + \frac{6}{x-2}$$

$\downarrow$ $x(x-2)$ on both sides

$$x-2 \neq 0$$

$$x \neq 2$$

Domain

No
Solutions

$$3x = \left(1 + \frac{6}{x-2}\right)(x-2)$$

$$3x = 1(x-2) + \frac{6}{(x-2)}(x-2)$$

$$3x = x - 2 + 6$$

$$\Rightarrow 3x = x + 4 \Rightarrow 2x = 4 \Rightarrow x = 2$$

$$\therefore x^2 - 16 = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow x^2 = 16, \quad x = \pm \sqrt{16}$$

$$x = +4 \text{ or } -4$$

Factor? $x^2 - 16 = (x-4)(x+4)$

$$(x-4)(x+4) = 0$$

one of these
has to be 0

Solve: $\frac{1}{x+4} + \frac{3}{x-4} = \frac{3x+8}{x^2-16}$

domain
 $x \neq 4, -4$

$$\frac{1}{x+4} + \frac{3}{x-4} = \frac{3x+8}{(x+4)(x-4)}$$

$$\frac{x-4}{(x+4)(x-4)} + \frac{3(x+4)}{(x+4)(x-4)} = \frac{3x+8}{(x+4)(x-4)}$$

$$x-4 + 3(x+4) = 3x+8$$

$$x+8 = 8 \Rightarrow x = 0$$

that the equation
is identity:

$$(4x-3)^2 - 16x^2 = 9 - 24x$$

$$(a+b)^2 = a^2 + 2ab + b^2$$

$$(4x)^2 - 2(4x)(3) + 3^2$$

$$16x^2 - 24x + 9$$

$$\cancel{16x^2} - \cancel{24x} + \cancel{9} - \cancel{16x^2} = \cancel{9} - \cancel{24x}$$

$$0 = 0$$

that the equation

is identity:

$$\frac{3x^2+8}{x} = \frac{8}{x} + 3x$$

Domain $x \neq 0$

$$\frac{3x^2+8}{x}$$

$$\frac{3x^2}{x} + \frac{8}{x}$$

$$= \frac{3x}{1} + \frac{8}{x}$$

$$\frac{8}{x} + \frac{3x}{1} \quad \text{LCD} = x$$

$$= \frac{8}{x} + \frac{3x \cdot x}{x}$$

$$= \frac{8 + 3x^2}{x}$$

Are the following equations equivalent?

$$\frac{8x}{x-7} = \frac{72}{x-7}$$

domain
 $x \neq 7$

$$x-3=6$$
$$x=9$$

$$\frac{8x}{x-7} = \frac{72}{x-7}$$

$\downarrow$

$$8x = 72$$

$\downarrow$

$$x = 9$$

$\nwarrow$ because $x \neq 7$

the following
equations equivalent?

$$\frac{8x}{x-7} = \frac{56}{x-7}$$

domain
 $x \neq 7$

$$\frac{8x}{x-7} = \frac{56}{x-7} \quad \begin{array}{l} \cdot (x-7) \text{ valid} \\ \text{since } x \neq 7 \end{array}$$

$$8x = 56$$

$$\downarrow$$
$$x = 7$$

contradiction
type equation

$$2x - 4 = 10$$

$$\downarrow$$
$$2x = 14$$

$$\downarrow$$
$$x = 7$$